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Bread or Bombs (1963–1965)

> *For what it's worth, my feeling (and Bob Komer's, too) is that we're the victims of an inevitable falling off in US/Indian relations from the high point of Winter 1962. There's no use blaming ourselves unduly that neither Washington nor Delhi can sustain the high pitch of collaboration which emerged from the Chicom attack. We've had trouble on our side sustaining the momentum of our relationship, but the Indian slate is by no means clean either.*
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> —McGeorge Bundy, US national security adviser, 1964[1]

Between 1963 and 1968, a common perception of China as a threat motivated the US and India's continuing efforts to nurture a strategic partnership. The two countries had a shared interest: containing China. This agreement on ends laid the basis for cooperation, but US-India disagreement on means—how to contain China—prevented the deepening of the partnership and eventually led to its unraveling. The two countries differed on whether China was a short-term or a long-term threat to India, as well as whether it posed more of an external or internal threat.

They also disagreed about the optimum balance of resources that should be devoted to Indian development and defense to strengthen the country against China. Furthermore, while the US saw Pakistan as part of the solution to the China challenge, India saw it as part of the problem. Finally, India's strategy of diversifying its dependence proved to be an obstacle to deeper relations. The US saw the Indian political and military relationship